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INDIAN POLITY

For Civil Services and State Services Examinations

M LAXMIKANTH

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Mamadgi Anjali
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and
My Native Place
Dhanasiri (Zaheerabad - Telangana)*

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Preface to the Seventh Edition

I am pleased to place before the readers a thoroughly revised, enlarged and updated edition of this widely read book on Indian Polity.

In 2011 and 2013, the UPSC changed the pattern and syllabus of the preliminary and main examinations, respectively. Both times, the scope of Indian Polity has been considerably increased. Hence, this new edition of the book is more relevant now and is aimed to meet the expanded needs of the aspirants.

In the course of revision and updation of this edition of the book, various new developments related to the subject, like recent constitutional amendments, parliamentary legislations, executive decisions and supreme court judgments, have been taken into account.

Changes in this Edition:

1. Addition of 12 new chapters
2. Addition of 1 new Appendix
3. Inclusion of 2020, 2021, 2022 and 2023 preliminary questions with answers
4. Inclusion of 2020, 2021 and 2022 main questions
5. Updation of the year-wise break-up of the UPSC questions in the preliminary and main examinations
6. Inclusion of additional updated information on a number of topics
7. New items included in various chapters

New Chapters:

1. Concept of the Constitution
2. Consumer Commissions
3. Constitutional Prescriptions
4. National Commission for Women
5. National Commission for Protection of Child Rights
6. National Commission for Minorities
7. Bar Council of India
8. Law Commission of India
9. Delimitation Commission of India
10. Landmark Judgements and their Impact
11. Important Doctrines of Constitutional Interpretation
12. World Constitutions

New Appendix:

1. Constitutional Amendments with Reference to Articles

I firmly believe that this is now a very comprehensive and updated manual. It is a matter of immense satisfaction that the previous six editions of this book have received an overwhelming response from readers. I am confident that readers would continue to repose their faith in this edition as well.

Constructive comments and concrete suggestions to further improve the book are welcome and shall be gratefully acknowledged.

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Preface to the First Edition

I have great pleasure in placing this book before the aspirants of the top administrative services. The book has been written to meet the growing requirements of the candidates appearing for the Civil Services Examinations (Preliminary and Main) conducted by the Union Public Service Commission. It directly and fully covers the Indian Polity section of the paper on General Studies and is also useful for certain optional subjects like Public Administration, Political Science, Law, Sociology and Anthropology.

This comprehensive volume would enable the readers to acquire a complete and detailed understanding of the subject. It covers all dimensions (constitutional, non-constitutional, political and administrative) of the subject. My first-hand experience of coaching the candidates for the Civil Services Examinations has been a great source of inspiration and has helped me immensely in writing this book.

An effort has been made to make the contents of the book relevant, authentic, and up-to-date. The constitutional provisions are explained in the light of the debates of the Constituent Assembly of India as well as the judgements of the Supreme Court and the high courts. I have also used tables to make the presentation more clear. The Appendices, provided at the end of the book, serve as a reference section.

I welcome all constructive comments and concrete suggestions from the readers of this book.

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During the course of writing this book, I have received help, encouragement and assistance from my teachers, students, family members, colleagues, friends, library staff and others. I am thankful to all of them.

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I have also used and included information, data, annual reports, other reports and committee/commission reports available on the official websites of the various ministries, departments and organisations of the Government of India. These include the Ministry of Home Affairs, Inter-State Council Secretariat, Election Commission of India, Cabinet Secretariat, Lok Sabha Secretariat, Rajya Sabha Secretariat, Digital Sansad, Ministry of Parliamentary Affairs, Ministry of Finance, Indian Parliamentary Group, Supreme Court of India, Ministry of Personnel, Public Grievances and Pensions, Ministry of Law and Justice, National Legal Services Authority, Ministry of Consumer Affairs, Food and Public Distribution, Ministry of Panchayati Raj, Ministry of Housing and Urban Affairs, Ministry of Tribal Affairs, Union Public Service Commission, Finance Commission of India, Goods and Services Tax Council, National Commission for SCs, National Commission for STs, National Commission for BCs, Commissioner for Linguistic Minorities, Comptroller and Auditor General of India, NITI Aayog, National Human Rights Commission, Central Information Commission, Central Vigilance Commission, Central Bureau of Investigation, Lokpal, National Investigation Agency, National Disaster Management Authority, Ministry of Culture, Ministry of Social Justice and Empowerment, National Foundation for Communal Harmony, Ministry of External Affairs, Press Information Bureau, National Commission for Women, National Commission for Protection of Child Rights, National Commission for Minorities, Ministry of Minority Affairs, Bar Council of India, Law Commission of India and others.

The other sources of material were the news items and articles published in The Hindu, The Indian Express, The Times of India, Yojana and Kurukshetra as well as the official websites of the Governments of the USA, the UK, the France, the Japan, the Russia, the China and the Switzerland.

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